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NETWORK-AS-A-SERVICE (NAAS)

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WHAT IS NETWORK-AS-A-SERVICE (NAAS)?

Imagine you're building a house. Traditionally, you'd buy bricks, cables, tools — and build everything from scratch. That's how traditional networking works: routers, switches, cables, configurations — all owned and managed by you.

But what if instead of building, you could subscribe to a ready-made smart house? Just pay a monthly fee and manage everything from your phone.

That's NaaS.

It's a cloud-based model where businesses rent networking services (like firewalls, VPNs, switches, etc.) from a provider instead of owning hardware.

You consume networking on-demand, just like electricity or cloud storage.

HOW IT WORKS

Think of NaaS as a cloud portal + intelligent infrastructure behind the scenes.

Here's the flow:

- You log in to a web dashboard or use an API.
- You define your network needs (e.g., 5 branch offices, secure access, 10Gb bandwidth).
- The NaaS provider handles the backend setup — routing, firewalls, connectivity, etc.
- You monitor and manage everything via the portal — no need to touch physical devices.

Technologies involved:

- SD-WAN (software-defined WAN)
- Virtualized network functions (firewall, load balancer as software)
- Cloud-native tools like automation, monitoring, and analytics

In short: You define what you want → They provision it → You manage it with ease.

KEY FEATURES

NaaS isn't just about renting network hardware — it's about transforming the network into a smart, service-oriented platform. Here are some core features explained simply:

Feature	Explanation
Virtualized Network Functions (VNFs)	Traditional hardware like firewalls, routers, and load balancers become software components — running in the cloud. Easier to update, scale, and manage.
Self-Service Portals	You don't need to SSH into a router — you configure your entire network via a user-friendly dashboard or API.

Feature	Explanation
End-to-End Visibility	You can monitor traffic flows, detect issues, and analyze usage in real-time. This helps in quick troubleshooting and optimization.
Flexible Deployment	Whether your infrastructure is fully cloud, hybrid, or on-prem — NaaS adapts to your setup.

So it's not just a replacement for routers — it's a smarter way to do networking.

BENEFITS OF NAAS

So why are companies switching to NaaS? It's not just about convenience — it's a strategic decision.

KEY BENEFITS:

- **No hardware management:** No more buying, upgrading, or maintaining switches and firewalls.
- **Faster deployments:** Need a new office connected securely? Configure it in minutes.
- **Cost efficiency:** Pay only for what you use. No upfront CapEx, only predictable OpEx.
- **Scalability:** Easily scale your bandwidth or users as your business grows.
- **Built-in security:** Most NaaS solutions include firewalls, VPN, encryption, and threat detection.

- **Smart analytics:** Understand traffic behavior, detect anomalies, and optimize usage — all from one dashboard.

WHO PROVIDES IT?

Many companies are moving fast into the NaaS space. Each one offers different levels of flexibility, cloud support, and integration.

Provider	What they offer
Cisco Meraki NaaS	Cloud-managed networking with built-in security and SD-WAN. Great for branch offices and remote setups.
HPE Aruba NaaS	Focused on enterprise-grade wired/wireless networks, with AI-driven insights and automation.
AWS Cloud WAN	Integrates cloud-native networking across multiple regions and clouds — ideal for global cloud-first companies.
Megaport	Provides fast, elastic, and private interconnection between data centers and cloud services.

Provider	What they offer
Aryaka	Offers SD-WAN and SASE (Secure Access Service Edge) as a managed service with high performance.



We're currently working on the final adjustments of PentoraX to ensure a stable and polished version for public release. If you have ideas, suggestions, or would like to contribute in any way, feel free to reach out — we'd love to hear from you.



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